

Readiness Proposal

Union of the Comoros

29 May 2015



GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND

Executive Summary <i>(in one page)</i>	
Country (or region)	Union of the Comoros
Submission Date	29/05/2015
NDA or Focal Point	Mr. Youssouf Hamadi
Contact Point (both NDA/FP and delivery partner)	Focal Point: Name: Mr. Youssouf Hamadi Position: Head of the Department Email: yous.hamadi@gmail.com Tel: +269 333 07 90 Full Office address: The Directorate General for Environment and Forests Ministry of Production, Environment, Energy, Industry et Handicrafts P.O. Box 41, Moroni – Comoros Tel: +269 77899 / 3331210 Union of the Comoros Delivery Partner: <u>Contact Point on operational issues:</u> Dionyssia Geka Deputy Director Office for Operations (OfO) United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) P. O. Box 30552 00100 Nairobi, Kenya Tel: +254- 20-512- 3993 mobile +254- (0)70-902-3993 email: dionyssia.geka@unep.org <u>Contact Point on technical issues:</u> Ermira Fida Head GEF Climate Change Adaptation Unit United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) Division for Environmental Policy and Implementation (DEPI) Block II, South wing, First floor P.O.Box 30552, (00100) Nairobi, Kenya Office land line: (254-20) 76 23113 Mobile: + 254 714 636329 Email: ermira.fida@unep.org

Readiness Area/s	☒ 1. Establishing and strengthening National Designated Authorities (NDAs) or Focal Points
	☒ 2. Strategic frameworks for engagement with the Fund, including the preparation of country programmes
	☐ 3. Selection of implementing entities or intermediaries, and support for accreditation
	☐ 4. Initial pipelines of programme and project proposals
	☐ 5. Information Sharing, experience exchange and learning
Request Summary (in 200 words)	The impacts of climate change are expected to pose a significant risk to the livelihoods and well-being of Comorian communities. More frequent and severe storms and floods, combined with increased temperatures reduced overall rainfall are projected to lead to increased soil erosion, reduced water availability and quality, and decreased agricultural production. At the same time, the country lacks the technical capacity and financial resources to overcome and cope with the anticipated changes. The Green Climate Fund (GCF) Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme activities will contribute to strengthening the country's technical and coordination capacity, with a view to enhancing its access to adequate climate financing to address climate threats and implement identified priorities for action. The initial phase of the Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme will focus on (i) the strengthening of the National Designated Authority (NDA) / Focal Point (activity 1), and (ii) the development of strategic frameworks for engagement with the Fund, including the preparation of a country programme (activity 2). As a result of the readiness programme activities, it is expected that an appropriate NDA is identified, and its institutional capacities are built to effectively fulfill its roles and responsibilities in relation to the Fund. The programme will also facilitate the development, through a stakeholder engagement process, of a country programme, which will include programming priorities and programme/project concepts.
Anticipated Duration	01/07/2015 – 30/06/2017 (24 months)
Estimated total cost	US\$ 300,000

SECTION A: RATIONALE FOR REQUEST

A.1

Background

Please provide country overview including initiatives related to climate finance e.g. NAMAs NAPs... etc.

An increase in annual temperature of around 1°C has been noted over the last thirty years in Comoros, as well as a shortening of the rainy season and an increase in the frequency of severe rainfall events and flooding. A decrease in river flows has also been noted as well as an earlier drying of rivers at the end of the rainy season, leading to a reduction in water availability for drinking, irrigation and hydro-electricity production. This increasing aridity is also marked by an agricultural water deficit. Historical observation has shown a trend towards the increase of extreme meteorological phenomena during the last thirty years.

Future climate change is likely to increase storms and their severity, exacerbate climate variability and increase the rapidity of sea level rise. Climate change projections for the Comoros include a decline in rainfall of between 2 and 14% during the dry season by 2090. Projections also include an increase in mean annual temperature of between 0.8 and 2.1°C by 2060, and of 1.2 to 3.6°C by 2090, and expected 20 cm rise in sea level by 2050.

It is expected that the increase in air temperature combined with high intensity rainfall events will contribute to accelerating the process of soil erosion in Comoros, given the fragility the soil, and lead to a decrease in agricultural production. This will severely impact the livelihoods of Comorians and the Comorian economy. Furthermore, the supply of water is currently insufficient to meet the needs of the Comorian population. Negative climate change impacts will exacerbate the shortage of water supply and water quality, both of which are already affected by inadequate management of watershed resources and deforestation.

The impacts of climate change in Comoros and the priorities for action have been articulated in its National Adaptation Programme of Action (NAPA) which was completed in 2006, as well as the Technology Needs Assessment (TNA) (2006) and first and second UNFCCC National Communications (2003 and 2013). The NAPA identifies loss of water bodies, drought and low flows, and climate-related storms as major threats and hazards to Comoros. It also identifies reduced water /groundwater depletion, food security and income generation as the main vulnerabilities to climate change.

A.2

Justification for request

Please explain how the readiness request is aligned with country priorities and strategies and how it is linked with existing climate finance initiatives in country.

In 2011, the Government of the Comoros signed with 18 UN agencies a manifesto for partnership for green development in Comoros. In this manifesto, the Government reiterates its commitment to steer the country in a sustainable growth, green and climate

resilient development pathway. At the same time, the Comorian communities, autonomous islands' governments, and the national government lack the technical capacity, management capacity, physical resources and financial resources to overcome and cope with the anticipated changes in climatic conditions. This would require significant human and financial resources, which Comoros as a Least Developed Country (LDC) and a Small Island Developing State (SIDS) cannot raise solely from its domestic resources. The Green Climate Fund (GCF) Readiness and Preparatory Support activities will contribute to strengthening the country's technical and coordination capacity, with a view to enhancing its access to adequate climate financing to address climate threats and implement the identified priorities for action.

The activities proposed for the GCF Readiness and Preparatory Support initiative are aligned with Comoros' national plans, strategies, laws and policies which incorporate climate change considerations. These include (i) the Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy (2010-2015), (ii) the National Environmental Policy (NEP), supported by a National Action Plan (2011), and (iii) the Accelerated Growth & Sustainable Development strategy (SCA2D), as well as the agricultural strategy (being updated), the energy strategy, and other sectoral programmes.

As the GCF is a new financial mechanism accessible to the country, Comoros would like to ensure that

- i. a unique role is identified for the Fund's operations in the country, which is complementary to both domestic and existing international resources available, and that
- ii. specialist capacities within government are in place to provide focused attention to and ensure alignment between the country's priorities and the Fund's investment mandate.

To this end, and following several exchanges with the GCF secretariat, including a meeting with Comoros' GCF Focal Point at the UNFCCC COP20 in Lima, the focus of the initial Readiness and Preparatory Support request has been defined as (i) the strengthening of the National Designated Authority (NDA) / Focal Point (activity 1), and (ii) the development of strategic frameworks for engagement with the Fund, including the preparation of a country programme (activity 2).

In parallel with the activities under the Readiness and Preparatory Support initiative, Comoros will work with its partners on the consultation, development and validation of a project pipeline for eventual submission for consideration by the GCF.

Related climate finance initiatives & activities

Comoros has a number of climate-related projects and programmes currently underway. These include:

- A climate-change related agriculture project, in partnership with UNDP and the GEF
- A programme to strengthen the country's resilience to climate change, funded by

the EU

- An adaptation project in the water sector, in partnership with UNDP, UNEP, and the GEF
- An integrated water resource management project, in partnership with UNOPS

A few additional projects/programmes are also currently being developed, such as:

- A project for the rehabilitation of forests and watersheds, in partnership with UNEP and the GEF
- A project for the advancement of the National Adaptation Plan (NAP) in partnership with UNDP
- The preparation of Comoros' INDC with the support from the French Government
- The development of a policy, a strategy and an action plan for effectively engaging with COMESA (Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa)

The activities applied for in this proposal do not overlap with any existing readiness support offered by other entities, and will build on the ongoing and planned initiatives outlined above.

SECTION B: SCOPE OF WORK

B.1 Description of activities

If consultancy service is required to undertake proposed activities, please also include a brief terms of reference of the service in this section or as an annex.

The initial phase of the Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme will focus on the standardised readiness package for (i) the strengthening of the National Designated Authority (NDA) / Focal Point (activity 1), and (ii) the development of strategic frameworks for engagement with the Fund, including the preparation of a country programme (activity 2). These activities are described below, with a detailed logical framework included as Annex I.

The readiness programme will be launched with a national workshop that will help to:

- Raise awareness about the GCF and identify an appropriate institutional arrangement that can facilitate collaboration between the country and the Fund;
- Identify adaptation and mitigation priorities of the Government and stakeholders, including projects and/or priority programmes, which could be financed by the Fund;
- Identify relevant regional and/or international bodies already accredited by the Fund that can support the country to develop a priority project/programme for submission to the Fund by the end of the year; and
- Identify national, regional and/or international entities positioned for accreditation by the Fund, with the aim of having at least one of them presenting an application for accreditation by the end of the year.

Activity 1: Establishing and Strengthening the National Designated Authority (NDA)

The Focal Point (FP) in collaboration with the delivery partner will recruit short-term

experts to strengthen the capacity of the Focal Point and eventually the NDA (once designated). A combination of national and international experts is envisaged to support the FP/NDA to carry out the following tasks:

1. Identifying the appropriate institutional structure that will support collaboration between the Government and the GCF, and facilitate its nomination as the NDA;
2. Strengthening the knowledge and capacities of the NDA coordination team to fulfil its roles and responsibilities;
3. Coordination and liaison with other ministries, relevant departments and agencies on key issues relating to the GCF, including consultations on the development of a country programme; and
4. Building the capacity of the NDA to engage stakeholders and organising multi-party consultations.

The FP/NDA may also add other activities in accordance with the Fund's defined scope of work in the Standardised Package for NDA or Focal Point Strengthening, available at: http://www.gcfund.org/fileadmin/00_customer/documents/Accreditation/Scope_of_Work_Pack_age_1_NDA_Strengthening.pdf.

Activity 2: Strategic Engagement Framework with the Fund

The FP/NDA will lead the development of a country programme, including the following tasks:

1. Identifying the government's mitigation and adaptation priorities in accordance with the Accelerated Growth and Sustained Development Strategy (SCA2D: 2015-2019), the agricultural strategy being updated, the energy strategy, other sectoral programmes and the Fund's Initial Results Management Framework;
2. Identifying a list of programmes and projects, including public-private partnerships, consistent with the Fund's Initial Investment Framework;
3. Identifying opportunities to engage the private sector, including micro, small and medium-sized enterprises, and to leverage their capacity to implement programming priorities;
4. Identifying the roles of prospective public and private sector entities that may be accredited by the Fund in implementing Comoros' programming priorities with respect to the Fund;
5. Identifying how the GCF can build on the ongoing work of other development partners in the country, and deliver its support in a manner complementary to the efforts of other partners; and
6. Organizing a stakeholder consultation processes for the development of the country programme.

The NDA may add other elements to the country programme and will also undertake stakeholder consultations in a manner that is consistent with the Fund's defined scope of work in the Standardised Package for Country Strategic Frameworks, available at: http://www.gcfund.org/fileadmin/00_customer/documents/Accreditation/Scope_of_Work_Pack_age_2_Country_Programme.pdf.

B.2	Expected results																																				
Activity 1: Appropriate NDA identified, and its institutional capacities built to effectively fulfil its roles and responsibilities in relation to the Fund Activity 2: Development, through a stakeholder engagement process, of a country programme to include elements provided in the Fund's <i>Initial general guidelines for country programmes</i>, which will include programming priorities and programme/project concepts consistent with the Fund's <i>Initial results management framework</i> and <i>Initial investment framework</i>																																					
SECTION C: BUDGET (include total cost and share of GCF funding) Please insert a summary table from the budget template (in a separate MS Excel form) as below. e.g. A detailed budget will be provided with the inception report. Based on the guidance from the standardised package for activities 1 and 2, the following high-level, indicative budget breakdown is envisaged: <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>BUDGET</th> <th>Sous Total (US\$)</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Activity 1:</td> <td></td> </tr> <tr> <td>Consultant fees:</td> <td>65,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Consultant travel and per diems:</td> <td>20,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Workshops:</td> <td>50,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Other costs (including audit fees):</td> <td>7,500</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Contingency:</td> <td>7,500</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Delivery partner fee: TBC</td> <td></td> </tr> <tr> <td>sous-Total 1</td> <td>150,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Activity 2:</td> <td></td> </tr> <tr> <td>Consultant fees:</td> <td>65,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Consultant travel and per diems:</td> <td>20,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Workshops:</td> <td>50,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Other costs (including audit fees):</td> <td>7,500</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Contingency:</td> <td>7,500</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Delivery partner fee: TBC</td> <td></td> </tr> <tr> <td>sous-Total 2</td> <td>150,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Grand TOTAL</td> <td>300,000</td> </tr> </tbody> </table> The government counterpart contribution is expected to reach 10% of the estimated total cost (up to US\$30,000), in kind (office space, furniture, utilities, etc.), for the duration of the project. The FP anticipates that the country may need additional resources to fully undertake activities to strengthen the NDA and develop a country programme, and it may supplement the Fund's resources with additional resources from other development		BUDGET	Sous Total (US\$)	Activity 1:		Consultant fees:	65,000	Consultant travel and per diems:	20,000	Workshops:	50,000	Other costs (including audit fees):	7,500	Contingency:	7,500	Delivery partner fee: TBC		sous-Total 1	150,000	Activity 2:		Consultant fees:	65,000	Consultant travel and per diems:	20,000	Workshops:	50,000	Other costs (including audit fees):	7,500	Contingency:	7,500	Delivery partner fee: TBC		sous-Total 2	150,000	Grand TOTAL	300,000
BUDGET	Sous Total (US\$)																																				
Activity 1:																																					
Consultant fees:	65,000																																				
Consultant travel and per diems:	20,000																																				
Workshops:	50,000																																				
Other costs (including audit fees):	7,500																																				
Contingency:	7,500																																				
Delivery partner fee: TBC																																					
sous-Total 1	150,000																																				
Activity 2:																																					
Consultant fees:	65,000																																				
Consultant travel and per diems:	20,000																																				
Workshops:	50,000																																				
Other costs (including audit fees):	7,500																																				
Contingency:	7,500																																				
Delivery partner fee: TBC																																					
sous-Total 2	150,000																																				
Grand TOTAL	300,000																																				

partners. **The delivery partner's fees will be included but are yet to be confirmed. We will adjust the other line items in a pro-rated manner to cover the fees within the overall envelope of US\$ 150,000.**

SECTION D: IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

D.1 Implementation arrangements

Please include information on delivery partners.

United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) has been selected as Comoros' delivery partner for the GCF Readiness and Preparatory Support Programme. UNEP has considerable experience in implementing projects and providing scientific guidance in the field of climate change. To date, UNEP has facilitated the completion of 15 NAPAs and has assisted 38 countries in developing National Communications. It has also implemented or is in the process of implementing approximately 80 adaptation projects at global, regional and national levels.

UNEP has considerable experience in helping countries in accessing climate finance, in particular in partnership with the GEF, as well as through the capacity building and technical support given to countries to gain direct access to the Adaptation Fund. UNEP is also currently implementing, in partnership with UNDP and WRI, a programme to strengthen countries' readiness to access the GCF.

While UNEP will take the responsibility for fiduciary management of the readiness funding, the FP (and later the NDA) will lead the implementation process of this programme in collaboration with UNEP. UNEP and the NDA will identify and hire individual consultants or a consulting firm to deliver Activities 1 and 2 in accordance with the procurement plan and a detailed implementation plan, both of which will be further elaborated in the inception report.

D.2 Disbursement schedule

The funding will be transferred to UNEP, as the delivery partner, in three tranches:

- The first disbursement, which amounts US\$ 100,000 (US\$ 50,000 for Activity 1 and US\$ 50,000 for Activity 2), will be transferred upon the submission of an inception report from UNEP to the Fund, in form and substance acceptable to the Fund, which includes detailed implementation plan, procurement plan and budget;
- The second tranche of US\$ 100,000 will be transferred upon submission of an interim progress report and audited financial report, in form and substance acceptable to the Fund, including an expenditure statement; and
- The final disbursement of US\$ 100,000 will be made upon submission of a completion report and financial report, including an audited expenditure statement.

D.3	Procurement plan				
<i>Please provide detailed procurement plan including methods.</i> UNEP, in collaboration with the FP/NDA, will competitively procure services consistent with the UN procurement rules and regulations, outlined in the UN procurement manual. Consultants will be procured on a competitive basis and the terms of reference of consultants will be developed further to include the tasks outlined in the request summary above. The FP/NDA may also add other tasks to the ToRs of the consultants in accordance with the Fund's defined scope of work on NDA strengthening within the resource envelope in this proposal and any supplementary resources secured from other sources. Information on the process and the results of procurement to undertaken will be included in the inception report where such information can be provided in advance, and in any case, in the interim progress or completion reports when such procurement has been undertaken and completed.					
SECTION E: MONITORING & REPORTING PLAN					
<i>Please describe the frequency and responsibility for monitoring the indicators, the source of information that will be used to measure the indicators and the timing for submitting the interim and final reports of the activities implemented and outputs and outcomes achieved.</i> The proposed programme will follow UNEP standards for monitoring, reporting and evaluation of processes and procedures. A monitoring and evaluation framework (covering both technical and financial aspects of the programme) will be set up, with oversight from the intersectoral committee for the readiness programme. The interim and final reports will be submitted as outlined in section D.2 (disbursement schedule), and will include reporting against the logical framework in Annex 1.					
SECTION F: RISK & MITIGATION MEASURES					
<i>Please describe the expected risks (external and internal) that could influence the timing and quality of the deliveries. Highlight if there might be critical risks that could compromise the overall implementation. For each risk, identify the possible early corrective measures that will be in place to avoid or mitigate any negative impact.</i>					
Description of risk	<table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Risk level</th> <th>Mitigation measures</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>1. Inefficiency arising from weak capacity of local stakeholders may create delays in project implementation.</td> <td>Medium The key capacity gaps of local stakeholders will be identified, and consideration will be given to which ones to address with the GCF resources, in line with the GCF <i>guidance on eligible costs for direct NDA or focal point funding</i>.</td> </tr> </tbody> </table>	Risk level	Mitigation measures	1. Inefficiency arising from weak capacity of local stakeholders may create delays in project implementation.	Medium The key capacity gaps of local stakeholders will be identified, and consideration will be given to which ones to address with the GCF resources, in line with the GCF <i>guidance on eligible costs for direct NDA or focal point funding</i> .
Risk level	Mitigation measures				
1. Inefficiency arising from weak capacity of local stakeholders may create delays in project implementation.	Medium The key capacity gaps of local stakeholders will be identified, and consideration will be given to which ones to address with the GCF resources, in line with the GCF <i>guidance on eligible costs for direct NDA or focal point funding</i> .				

2 Poor functioning of the intersectoral committee due in part to resource constraints.	Medium	Adequate human and financial resources will be allocated for the coordination platform in line with the GCF <i>guidance on eligible costs for direct NDA or focal point funding</i>, and for enhancing information dissemination through a wide range of media channels (radio, television, newspapers, etc.).
---	---------------	---



READINESS AND PREPARATORY SUPPORT PROPOSAL

PAGE 1 OF 12

Annex I. Logical Framework

	Description	Indicators	Baseline
Outcomes			
1	NDA established and its capacity strengthened to fulfill its GCF-related roles and responsibilities	i. The extent to which the identification and nomination of an NDA is consistent with the Fund's best practice guidelines ii. The extent¹ to which the DNA's capacity has been strengthened to: 1. Use the knowledge acquired on the country's climate- and development-related needs, priorities, strategies, plans, relevant institutions and stakeholders 2. Facilitate and coordinate a country coordination mechanism and multi-stakeholder engagement 3. Monitor, evaluate and maintain an overview of activities of the Fund 4. Disseminate information on the operational procedures of the Fund to country stakeholders, including in local languages	To be completed in inception and progress reports as specific activities are planned
2	Strategic framework for engagement with the	i. Country programme document which includes	

¹ To measure the extent to which the capacity of DNA is strengthened the following scoring scale is recommended::

1 = Very limited or no evidence of capacity

2 = Partially developed capacity

3 = Fully developed, demonstrated capacity



READINESS AND PREPARATORY SUPPORT PROPOSAL

PAGE 2 OF 12

	Fund developed	elements provided in the Fund's Initial Guidelines for Country Programmes, including programming priorities and programme/project concepts ii. Number of NDA-led stakeholder engagement processes undertaken	
Outputs			
1.1	Capacity building and training events targeting the NDA	i. Number of capacity building and training events organized	
2.1	Identified adaptation and mitigation needs, priorities, strategies and plans, and relevant institutions and stakeholders	i. List of the identified needs, priorities, strategies, plans, institutions and stakeholders	
2.2	Stakeholder consultations and coordination meetings for the development of the country programme	i. Number of multi-stakeholder meetings ii. Number of participants (government, civil society and private sector) included in the stakeholder engagement process with understanding about the GCF and its funding opportunities.	
2.3	The country programme, including elements provided in the Fund's Initial Guidelines for Country Programme	i. The finalized country programme	
Indicative activities - To be completed in inception and progress reports as specific activities are planned			